



Surging ahead: Despite emerging as India's lead spinner since the last T20 World Cup, leggie Ravi Bishnoi lost his World Cup spot to Yuzvendra Chahal, who has been picked on the back of his IPL form. AFP & EMMANUEL YOGINI

games since its group stage exit at the 2021 showpiece event. There was less than a year gap between the 2021 and 2022 editions.

With India's last T20I series coming more than four months out from this year's World Cup, beginning in June, the IPL naturally assumed greater significance.

This view was particularly vindicated when Rinku Singh didn't

find a place in India's squad for the World Cup in the United States and West Indies following an IPL season that paled in comparison to the breakout tournament he had last year. However, his batting position for Kolkata Knight Riders was an overbearing factor that played into Rinku's lukewarm returns. In 82 balls faced in eight innings, the southpaw struck 123 runs at a strike rate of 150

while batting at No. 6 and 7 six times.

But preceding the IPL this year, Rinku had a stellar run for India, which was on the lookout for a bonafide finisher in the run-up to the T20 World Cup. Since his India debut in August last year, Rinku has scored 356 runs in 11 innings at a strike rate of 176.23, the best return for any Indian batter with more than 10 runs during this period.